

has over 30 lakh job seekers and 2 lakh registered employers.

Sometimes already successful people also get bitten by the frustration bug, as happened to Beerud Sheth, CEO of Webaroo, the messaging company behind SMS GupShup. While trying to message people in his company using an existing enterprise messaging app, he got so frustrated, he broke his phone. "That's when I decided to launch a product which enables clutter free communication in an enterprise," says Beerud. That's how their product Teamchat was born.

Not all problems are local however; some are global. Livspace, an end-to-end décor and home design provider, was started because all three of its founding members (Anuj Srivastava, Shagufta Anurag and Ramakant Sharma) were frustrated with a lack of trying to design their homes. Let Anuj tell you in his words, "The idea of Livspace was inspired by our combined frustrations in India, USA, and Singapore while getting our homes designed and realising that instead of it being a fun, enjoyable experience — it's a nightmare!"

BE UNIQUE

It's not enough to go "Eureka!", and then just do something that's already being done or can be easily copied. Even when you see the need for something, and find that people in other countries are already doing it, you need to tailor fit your solution to the place and the people who will use it.

Let's start with the real world examples again; first up, Karthik Ramachandra, co-founder TripHobo. In the age where machines replace humans on a regular basis, he saw value in doing the opposite. At a time when most travel portals try and offer you a things to see list and try and throw up algorithm generated itineraries, tripHobo decided to focus on making user generated content more accessible. Karthik says, "People talk to other people to discuss and debate when they create a trip plan. This is something we've tried to replicate on the portal. With a massive repository of itineraries created by real travelers, one can easily find something that suits them. Users can edit and customise itineraries already on the portal, and then those get saved as more suggestions for other users."



Anuj Srivastava

Co-Founder and CEO
Livspace

It's also important to understand local needs, which may differ wildly from those abroad. MySmartPrice is a popular price comparison platform with 10 million users across India. Sitakanta Ray, Co-Founder and COO, says, "The product we built was in part inspired by Nextag (US) and Shopping.com (UK). However we tailored our product to the shopping needs of the country. For example, MySmartPrice has integrated the offers and coupons of var-

ious stores directly into the price table. So users don't need to go to another destination to find the best coupon for the product they are buying. We also show delivery and payment options such as COD, availability of EMI etc, all in advance."

You can also be unique by totally rethinking things inside a niche. All of us run in search for C.A.s to file our returns come tax season, and the founders of MeetUrPro.com already had experience in running web sites for people like us, with two successful sites that helped people file tax returns. However, as they sat around thinking what the next steps in their growth might be, they realised that they had to go beyond the people they could hire. Instead of trying to provide services, they decided to become the platform itself. "As we deliberated on the possibility of expanding the delivery team for multi-disciplinary consultation – we thought of bringing in multiple professionals as partners similar to a market place – hence the thought of MeetUrPro.com," says Divakar Vijayasarthi, Co-Founder MeetUrPro.com.

Then there are enterprise-level players who strike gold with an idea. Take JunoTele, a mobile payment technology company with solutions deployed in India, Sri-Lanka and Thailand. Most mobile micro payments happen using

Where do eureka's come from?

While there's no magic formula, it doesn't mean that there's no formula at all. For a headstart, read Paul Graham's brilliant and detailed essay titled 'How to get startup ideas'. To read it, head over to <http://dgit.in/GetStartupIdeas>

Straight from the horse's mouth

Learn directly from other entrepreneurs and successful businessmen on websites such as 'Quora', where asking a broad question in a relevant category (such as 'Startups') can reap some very high-quality answers. Meanwhile, due to the fact that so many successful tech industry figures are members of Quora, you can ask questions directly to them, or about them, and with a bit of luck you'll get an answer right from the horse's mouth.

'Mixergy' is another website where you can "learn from proven entrepreneurs" like Paul Graham and Jimmy Wales. These aren't five minute gloss overs, they're in depth and detailed descriptions of how these successful people got to where they are today.

If you can't be bothered to come up with your own ideas

Ideaswatch.com: Lets users share ideas and what they'd like in the market. You can even form a team of like-minded individuals to pursue an idea.

Springwise.com: Provides a collection of proven successful ideas from many countries to try out on your own.

Killerstartups.com: With over 15 new startups submitted everyday, the site is popular among early stage entrepreneurs looking to promote their babies.